

Friction Grid

A printable map for noticing where friction is gathering and choosing one small place to investigate.

The Friction Grid starts with everyday irritations: places you feel drained, overloaded, tense, resistant, or stuck. Instead of treating those moments as random, the grid helps you map them so patterns become visible.

What it is

A simple matrix that crosses life domains such as home, work, or self with sources of friction such as internal, relational, and structural strain.

What it does

It turns diffuse stress into a visible pattern so you can spot clusters, compare pressure points, and choose one practical place to experiment with change.

How to use it

1. Notice what leaves you drained, overloaded, irritated, frozen, or tense.
2. On the grid, mark each cell with a low, moderate, or high level of friction. Use dots, shading, initials, or short notes.
3. Look across the rows and columns. Which life domain carries the most strain? Which source of friction keeps repeating?
4. Use the reflection space to name one pattern and one small experiment that could reduce the load without demanding a total overhaul.

Suggested legend



Low friction



Moderate friction



High friction

You can rename any domain or source label to fit your life. A high mark invites investigation; it does not prove a personal, relational, or structural cause. This is an awareness tool, not clinical, medical, legal, or financial advice.

Friction Grid

Map your friction across life domains and sources. Shade, dot, or label each cell based on the level of strain it holds right now.

Quick key



Low



Moderate



High

Tip: rename the row labels or the source labels if another set of domains fits better. The pattern matters more than the exact wording.

	Internal	Relational	Structural
Home			
Work			
Faith			
Social			
Self			

Pattern snapshot

Highest-friction domain:
Highest-friction source:
Most concentrated cluster:
One small experiment:

Reflection prompts

Which cluster surprises you?

What stands out as a pattern?

If one high-friction cell became moderate, what might help?